Request for Proposal

Brand Positioning, Strategy, and Design

Proposals due March 14. This is a FICTIONAL sample document, written solely as a test fixture for this repository. Example Nutrition Co. is not a real company and no real brand, person, or RFP is described here.

Background

Example Nutrition Co. makes shelf-stable meals built around whole-food ingredients, with no added sugar. Our products are developed with an in-house nutrition science team and third-party tested for contaminants. We hold a purity certification from an independent testing nonprofit.

The company was founded by a research nutritionist who could not find a convenient product that met the nutrient profile her own work pointed to. Our formulation carries a proprietary blend of 16 target nutrients, which we believe is several times the density of conventional alternatives in the category.

Example Nutrition Co. is now an established brand facing well-funded competition. We have broad retail distribution and a substantial direct-to-consumer business, but our growth has flattened.

As the most nutrient-dense product in our category, Example Nutrition Co. needs to strengthen its competitive positioning, differentiation, and messaging so that it reads as both different and better in a crowded market, and so that customers can make an informed choice.

Objectives

- Strike a strong emotional chord between the brand and the target audience
- Clarify and strengthen an ownable market positioning to win share
- Develop a guided path for customers through the product lifecycle
- Secure durable preference for our products versus alternatives
- Refine the target audience and the insight that motivates it
- Guide product development toward the highest-growth opportunities
- Improve creative and content consistency across touchpoints

Intended impact

- Increase brand awareness, equity, trial, loyalty, and sales growth
- Drive higher shelf velocity in existing retail distribution
- Build confidence with retail buyers to hold and grow distribution
- Improve the engagement, efficiency, and impact of brand advertising
- Improve the success and longevity of new product launches

Scope

The elements below are in our brand positioning roadmap. Some or all could be handled by the same external agency partner.

- Brand identity refresh, including logo, color, and typography
- Style guide reflecting the refreshed identity
- Package design, shelf differentiators, and claims hierarchy
- Website design updated to reflect the new brand
- Campaign themes, headlines, and taglines
- Brand messaging: copy, claims, and supporting selling points
- Creative content: product photography, lifestyle photography, video
- Innovation strategy and an innovation opportunity map

Budget

We hold a placeholder budget for brand initiatives, but the final figure depends on the scope included and the strengths of the partner selected. Each prospective agency should provide a projected budget based on the areas its proposal covers, broken out by major portion, so we can decide whether to include some but not all items.

Projected timeline

- RFP sent to prospective partners
- Questions during the proposal stage, and final proposal submission
- Partner selection and contracting
- Official kickoff with a staffed agency team

What to include in your proposal

- Agency introduction: who you are, what you do well, how you work
- Core capabilities, particularly where they overlap this project
- First candid impressions of our brand and product line
- Proposal details: deliverable scope, estimated costs, estimated timeline
- Additional considerations we may not have contemplated in this RFP
- Agency team: the key people or roles that would be staffed
- Key contacts and contact information for this RFP process

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